



BSc (Hons) in **Information Technology**
Specialized in AI

IT3012 : Intelligent Agents

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026 Semester 2

Faculty of Computing

Practical 01

Objective & Lecture Mapping: Recall that an intelligent agent acts within a continuous loop: Sensors generate percept sequences, and Actuators execute actions to maximize a Performance measure. Use this sheet to execute practical modifications and incrementally evaluate your design against Lecture 01 and 02 theory (from basic recall to analytical classification).

Part 1: Code Analysis & PEAS Evaluation

Task 0 : Setting up and getting the starter Code

1. Go to the [Git Hub Repo](#). Create a Fork of this Git Repo to your Personal Github Profile. Open it using your favourite IDE and follow the below instruction to complete the practical. The base code is in the "master" branch of the repo.

Task 1.1: The Environment State (__init__)

1. (Remember) List the four components of the PEAS framework discussed in Lecture 01.

P – Performance Measure
E – Environment
A – Actuators



2. (Understand) Look at the `VisualGridHuntGame.__init__` method. Which specific variables in this code represent the physical "Environment (E)" state?

grid_width
grid_height
walls

3. (Analyze) Based on the variables initialized (specifically `self.opponents`), classify this baseline environment as "Single-Agent" or "Multi-Agent". Briefly justify your choice.

Multi-Agent

The presence of `self.opponents` indicates that other agents exist in the environment.

Task 1.2: The Perception Subsystem (`get_percept`)

4. (Remember) Define what a "percept sequence" is according to Lecture 01.

A percept sequence is the complete history of all percepts (sensor inputs) an agent has received from the environment over time.

5. (Understand) Which component of the PEAS framework does the `get_percept()` method represent in our code?

Sensors

6. (Evaluate) Based on the exact dictionary returned by `get_percept()` , is this environment "Fully Observable" or "Partially Observable"? Explain why based on what the agent can and cannot see.

Partially Observable

The agent only receives the information included in the dictionary returned by

Task 1.3: Action Execution (`execute_action`)

7. (Understand) When `execute_action()` deducts points for hitting a wall, which PEAS component is being actively updated?

Performance Measure

8. (Evaluate) Why is it structurally important that this metric evaluates changes in the external environment state (hitting a wall) rather than the agent's internal processing effort?

The performance measure should evaluate how successfully the agent achieves its goals, not how much computation it performs. Measuring external outcomes (such as collecting food or avoiding walls) reflects the agent's effectiveness, while internal

Part 2: Guided Modification & Deep Theory Mapping

Follow the implementation instructions to inject a new hazard, then answer the questions to map your code changes back to the theoretical nature of the environment.

Step 2.1: Extending the Environment Initialization (`__init__`)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** Declare a new trap collection attribute (e.g., `self.toxic_traps = set()`) inside `__init__`. Populate it with coordinate tuples safely avoiding position `(0, 0)`, walls, and food.

9. (Understand) If you successfully add `self.toxic_traps` to the environment but intentionally **hide** this data from the agent's sensors, how does this specifically alter the environment's "Observability" classification?

The environment becomes more Partially Observable.

Since the traps exist but cannot be directly sensed, the agent has incomplete

Step 2.2: Updating the Perception Subsystem (`get_percept`)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** Locate `get_percept(self)` and add a new boolean sensor key (e.g., `'smells_toxin': tuple(self.agent_pos) in self.toxic_traps`) to the dictionary returned to the agent loop.

10. (Analyze) By adding `'smells_toxin'`, you expand the agent's percept sequence. Explain how this specific sensor helps the agent act with "Rationality" (maximizing expected utility).

The smells_toxin sensor warns the agent when it is on a toxic trap. This additional information helps the agent avoid dangerous locations, make better decisions, reduce penalties, and maximize its expected utility.

Step 2.3: Modifying Action Execution & Visual Rendering (execute_action & draw_grid)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** In `execute_action`, check if the updated `self.agent_pos` intersects with `self.toxic_traps` to decrement `self.score` by 15 points. In `draw_grid`, iterate through traps to render custom purple shapes on the canvas.

11. (Remember) You programmed a severe score penalty for stepping on a trap to avoid metric exploitation. What was the classic "Vacuum World Exploit" example discussed in Lecture 01 that illustrated the danger of faulty metrics?

The classic Vacuum World exploit is when the agent repeatedly drops dirt and cleans it again to continuously earn reward points instead of actually completing the cleaning task. This demonstrates how a poorly designed performance measure can

Finalize and Lock Lab 01 Analytical Evaluation



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